

Tobias Treppmann

A design leader who still builds

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

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PORTFOLIO

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
Completed 2026

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

Craft and building

Prototyping in real code against production APIs · Android and Kotlin · SwiftUI · React and web · Claude Code, Cursor and Zed as daily tools · Selah, a macOS app designed, built and shipped solo on the Mac App Store

Visual and interaction quality

DTCG tokens in four tiers synced live to Figma and Android · checks in CI that refuse off-system work · WCAG contrast validated inside the color algorithm · custom motion easing curves

Leading and coaching designers

Nine reports across four disciplines at Ninox, on the senior leadership team · hired two, promoted two · ten years as a senior mentor at CareerFoundry, two at the Interaction Design Foundation

Research and analytics

Conversion and usage metrics · interviews recorded and analyzed with Claude · competitive analysis of the global apps entering a market · usertesting.com screening to reach hard-to-recruit users

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting.

PROFILE

I lead design functions and I never stopped building. At Ninox I ran design and, for four months, product as well: nine people across design, UX writing, product and data science. The last year has been hands-on by choice. The quality bar lives in the build, not in the review.

A consumer strategy reversed

research at Spreadshirt overturned what leadership wanted, and the mobile prototype went to production

Real code

prototypes run against production APIs, and engineering ships from that code

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web and connected TV) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- I prototype in code, not in specs — real code against real production APIs. Engineering ships from it.
- A quality bar the build enforces — six checks, identical on a laptop and in CI. They refuse work that has left the system, so review time goes to the things a check cannot see.
- UI quality across four surfaces — iOS, Android, web and connected TV, held by DTCG tokens in four tiers. One commit propagates everywhere.
- A color engine in OKLCH — k-means clustering rather than RGB, so artwork-driven themes carry even perceptual weight. WCAG contrast validated inside the algorithm.
- Audit, then improve against the numbers — a full experience audit and the redesign from it, taken through to implementation, with conversion and usage metrics read as standing practice.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Booking capability, embedded rather than bolted on — the internal plan was a standalone add-on; I argued for building it into the platform and delivered it that way. 70% less coordination time, 90% acceptance, then shipped to every customer.
- Accessibility past our own front door — we audited our website and also the websites customers build with the platform, for EU Accessibility Act compliance.
- Product management and all of product design at once — across six countries I wrote the specs and ran the ticket board engineering worked from.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Two functions at once, nine reports, four disciplines — Product Design and Product held together, July to October 2023. Senior Leadership Team throughout.
- Hired 2, promoted 2 — and coached the design lead through a strained engineering relationship.
- Prompt-to-database onboarding, with the CEO and technical co-founder — freelance, summer 2025. The AI-generated schema renders into the real data-model editor, not a chat preview.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Five years of data-dense interfaces — pivot tables, aggregated JSON views, result cards, filter logic. The hardest was the query-builder preview, where the result is a sample.
- Research as a habit, not an event — pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening to reach analysts working inside regulated banks and insurers.

UX Strategy Lead

2014 – 2016

Spreadshirt (international e-commerce, hundreds of thousands of consumers — 200+ people) · Leipzig, Germany

- Research that changed a consumer product's direction — leadership wanted a 60-second automated journey. Shop owners valued the design step most. The strategy moved, and the mobile prototype went to production.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · a decade reviewing and critiquing designers' work

Product & UX Strategist · *Hypoport hub SE* · 2021 – 2022 · Berlin / Lübeck, Germany

Mentor · *Interaction Design Foundation* · 2020 – 2022 · Remote

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA

Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA